



Incident handler's journal

Date: 22.05.2026	Entry: #1
Description	Documenting a cybersecurity incident
Tool(s) used	None
The 5 W's	• The incident was caused by a group of unethical hackers, who are known to attack organizations in health care and transport industries. • The hacker group accessed the system of a small US health care clinic and locked the access to the company data with the ransomware. • The incident was noticed on a Tuesday morning, at approximately 9:00 a.m. • The incident occurred at a small US health care clinic. • An employee opened the attachment that was included in the phishing mail, which enabled the threat.
Additional notes	This kind of incident can be prevented by educating employees on dangers of phishing in the first place.

Date: 25.05.2026	Entry: #2
Description	Documenting a cybersecurity incident
Tool(s) used	None
The 5 W's	• On December 22nd a little bit after 3 p.m. the employee received an email claiming that the sender has access to customer data. Six days later, the same employee received a second email from the threat actor where he provided the evidence of stolen data and a demand of 50,000\$. • The threat actor exploited a web application vulnerability, after which he gained access to the company's database.
Additional notes	In order to prevent future incidents, the organization should perform routine vulnerability scans and penetration testing.

Date: 26.05.2026	Entry: #3
Description	Documenting an alert
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal website, Sandbox environment
The 5 W's	• A little bit after 1 p.m. the employee received and opened a phishing email that contained the malicious attachment. • The sender is unknown, although the main suspects are unethical hackers and individuals that try to gain some access to customers' data in order to acquire some financial gain. • After an employee downloaded the malicious attachment, the IDS noticed the executable files and sent out the alert.
Additional notes	Also, as the first entry, this kind of incident can be prevented by educating employees on the dangers of phishing in the first place and implementing an effective IPS that could prevent the known malicious files from spreading.

Date: 27.05.2026	Entry: #4
Description	Documenting a phishing incident by playbook
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal website
The 5 W's	• Since the severity of the alert is medium, by the playbook we need to check the content of the potential phishing attempt. • We see that the email sender's address is suspicious (76tguyhh6tgfrt7tg.su), the content has some grammar errors, and most importantly - the mail contains an attachment, therefore, we also need to verify if the file hash is malicious or not. This can be done by passing the hash value into virustotal search - where we can see that the "54e6ea47eb04634d3e87fd7787e2136ccfbcc80ade34f246a12cf93bab527f6b" is a known trojan file. • We confirmed that the alert was indeed a true positive and we escalated the alert to the L2 SOC analyst.
Additional notes	